FARIA · 7 NOVEMBER 2026 · A LESSON FOR JEFF FRANZEN

Hartz and Hart Schaffner and Marx: names are not a pedigree

Lena Hartz and her daughter Anna belong to a Baltimore clothing family. Anna married Joseph Bank, and that story is the clothier lesson. Harry Hart and Max Hart belong to Chicago. The trade is the same. The name is similar. A pedigree is something else.

In Chicago the roots are a Hart brothers' shop in 1872. In 1879 Levi Abt and Marcus Marx joined them. Joseph Schaffner joined in 1887, and the familiar name Hart Schaffner & Marx is that company. Do not say the firm was formed after 1945. That year is the Baltimore buyout, in another city, of a Hartz share in a different business.

A careful history of Schaffner's migration, from the German Historical Institute's work, shows a network of people from near Worms. It shows how a young man entered a Chicago house. It does not show a contract with Baltimore. Some accounts say Abt and Marx left when Schaffner arrived. Others say Marx stayed. Those details conflict, they are not needed for this question, and they are not a bridge to the Hartzes. They are left out on purpose.

No partnership paper, no share ledger, and no family record found for this lesson ties the Baltimore Hartz firm to the Chicago company. Read that as a limit, not as a triumph. Not finding a document does not prove the families were strangers back in Europe. It does forbid the sentence "they were one house."

What would count? For a business, a partnership agreement, articles of incorporation, or a record of ownership. For kinship, a birth, a marriage, a ship's list, a census, or a will that names people on both sides. A German-sounding surname in the garment trade is the start of a search. It is not the result.

If a "Hart" in Chicago is needed for context, there is already another one. Cousins Abraham and Henry Hart had a different firm, also spoken of as Hart brothers, and it was not this company. Similar names inside one city are a warning, not a family tree. The Bank lesson has the Baltimore side. This page only refuses the false pedigree.

The illustrated lesson is download the PDF.

Sources

- Encyclopedia of Chicago, Hart, Schaffner & Marx: https://encyclopedia.chicagohistory.org/pages/2695.html

- Immigrant Entrepreneurship, "Joseph Schaffner": https://www.immigrantentrepreneurship.org/entries/joseph-schaffner/
- Encyclopedia.com, Hartmarx: https://www.encyclopedia.com/social-sciences-and-law/economics-business-and-labor/businesses-and-occupations/hartmarx-corp

Key facts

- Baltimore's Hartz family is part of the Jos. A. Bank story. Chicago's Harry and Max Hart are part of Hart Schaffner & Marx. They are not the same firm.
- The Chicago company grows from 1872, with Marx and Abt in 1879 and Schaffner in 1887. It was not formed after 1945.
- No business record or kinship record found here links the two. That does not prove there was never a remote family tie.
- A real link would be a partnership, an ownership record, or a civil document naming both sides. The same trade and a similar name are not that link.